

5. Washo (20 marks)

Problem designed by Yash Sinha

Consider the following sentences from Washo, and their English translations.

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| (1) <i>teliwehu basa' basa'ige da'mo'mo' sili</i> | The man gave to the woman the book that he wrote. |
| (2) <i>basa' digyisge teliwahu disili</i> | The man gave to me the book that I saw. |
| (3) <i>da'mo'mo' basa' basa'isge dipigelyayi</i> | I returned to the woman the book that she wrote. |
| (4) <i>basa' umbasa'ige teliwahu umsili</i> | You gave to the man the book that you wrote. |
| (5) <i>teliwehu basa' umsilisge dipigelyayi</i> | I returned to the man the book that he gave to you. |
| (6) <i>basa' umgyige da'mo'mo' umsili</i> | You gave to the woman the book that you saw. |
| (7) <i>teliwehu da'mo'mo' basa' silige gyi</i> | The man saw the book that he gave to the woman. |

Assignment 1 [Answer Booklet]: Translate the following sentences into English. If there are multiple translations possible, give all of them.

- a. *da'mo'mo' basa' umsilige basa'i*
- b. *teliwehu basa' disilisge digyi*
- c. *da'mo'mo' basa' disilisge dipigelyayi*

Assignment 2 [Answer Booklet]: Translate the following sentences into Washo.

- a. The man gave to me the book that I returned to him.
- b. You saw the book that you gave the woman.

Assignment 3: Explain how the language works by describing the order in which words are used in a sentence, the translations for different verbs and nouns, the way in which verbs and nouns get modified and any other things that you find interesting about the language.

Notes: (1) Washo is an endangered Native American language isolate spoken by the Washo on the California–Nevada border in the drainages of the Truckee and Carson Rivers, especially around Lake Tahoe. While there are only 20 elderly native speakers of Washo, since 1994 there has been a small immersion school that has produced many moderately fluent younger speakers. This problem is based on data from Emily Hanink's field work. (2) Some of the words in this problem have been altered slightly for ease of solvability; for the same reason, diacritics have been omitted.